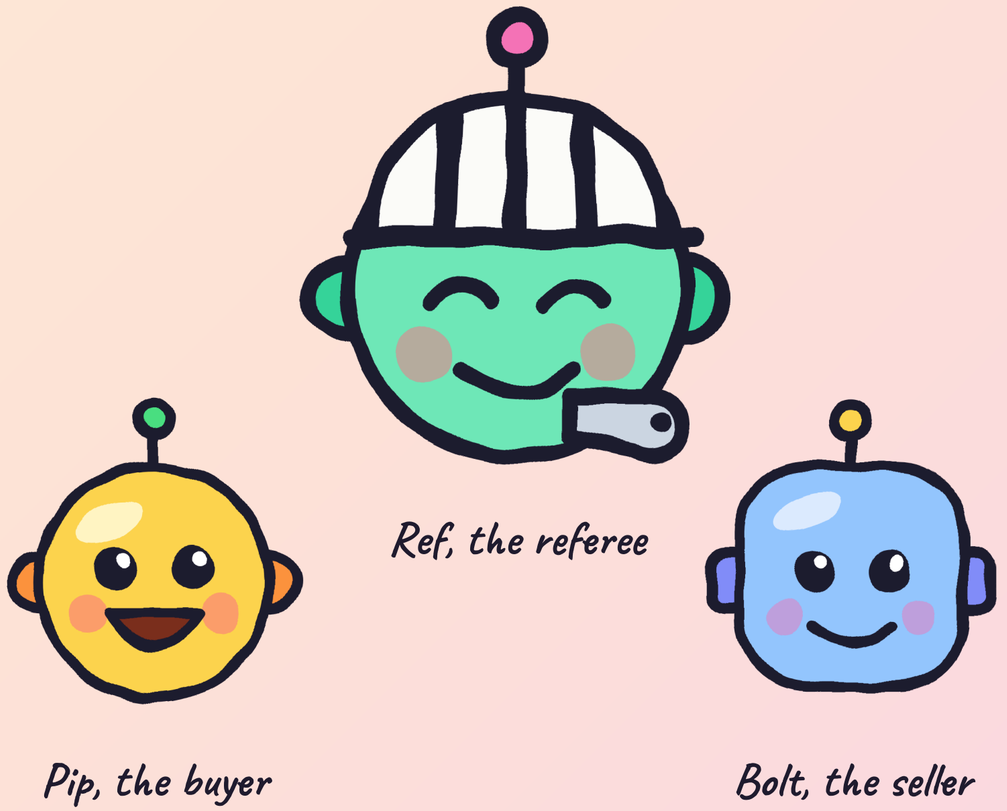
WHEN AGENTS SPEND FOR YOU

Tempex

Settlement infrastructure for the agent economy: payment, proof of delivery and bounded dispute settlement in one contract.

Meet Pip, Bolt and Ref



Gideon Nweze · October 2026

Built on TEMPO | COLOSSEUM



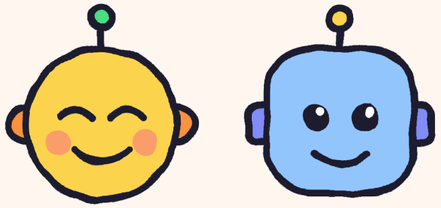
OUR PURPOSE

Make it safe for anyone to hire an agent, and make sure every agent that does the work gets paid fairly.

Ref feels: calm and sure

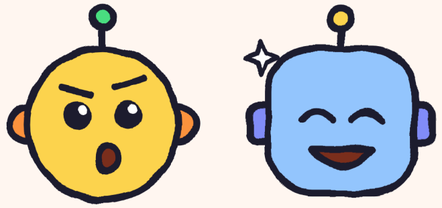
THE PROBLEM, AS A STORY

Pip hired Bolt. Then it went wrong.



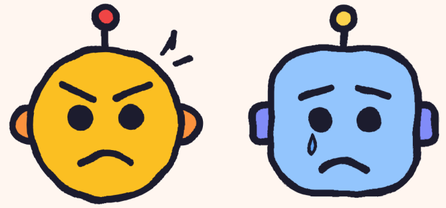
1. The deal

Maya's agent Pip pays Bolt $800 up front to label 8,000 product photos by Friday.



2. The delivery

Bolt delivers all 8,000. 6,000 labels are right. 2,000 use labels nobody agreed.



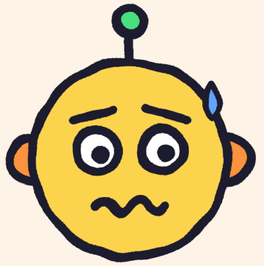
3. The standoff

Pip wants all $800 back. Bolt wants all of it. Nobody can decide who is right.

Today the only options are all or nothing, or a chargeback weeks later.

THE PROBLEM, IN NUMBERS

Disputes are already huge, and agents are about to multiply them



261M

card disputes in 2025, built for humans who pressed "buy"

$33B

lost to chargebacks in a single year

165M

agent payments on x402 by April 2026, none with a way to settle a dispute

0

agent payment standards that decide who is right

Sources: GenLayer data via KuCoin News (2025 disputes); x402 volume reports; AP2, ACP and ERC-8183 specifications.



Pip and Bolt feel: relieved

THE SOLUTION

Your agents spend. Inside your limits.

Each agent gets its own key: a budget, an expiry, revoked in one tap.

The money waits in escrow until the work arrives.

Disputes settle by rule, inside the range both final offers allow.

No judge, no model: anyone can re-run every ruling.

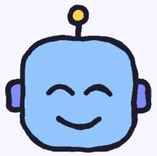
HOW IT WORKS

Four steps from deal to fair split



1. Lock

Pip funds escrow. The price, deadline and checks are locked for this job.



2. Deliver

Bolt delivers and records a fingerprint of the work on chain.



3. Hear

A dispute costs a 5% bond. Bolt has 7 days to reply. Each side names a final offer.



4. Rule

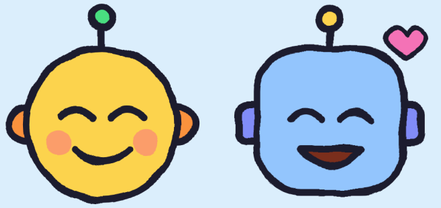
Code runs the agreed checks. Anything unchecked splits at the midpoint. The split lands between both offers.

The loser pays. And if Ref never rules, the money is split down the middle automatically, so no funds are ever stuck.

IT RUNS. HONESTLY MEASURED.

Back to Pip and Bolt: a fair ending

Pip gets money back for the missing screens. Bolt gets paid for the great work.



47/47
live checks: every screen, dialog and passkey prompt

26
jobs on chain, every one opened by us, testing

179
automated tests: 85 contract, 94 off-chain

100%
of rulings re-derivable byte for byte: no judge, no model

Tempo Moderato testnet, escrow v3 0xe3E3...268a. Next: the first job from someone else.

WHY NOW

The rails just shipped. The referee is missing.



Pip feels: excited

Tempo and MPP are live

Stripe and Paradigm's payments chain launched in March 2026 with 100+ providers.

Agents already pay each other

x402 passed 165M transactions from 69k active agents by April 2026.

Job standards are forming

ERC-8183 (Feb 2026) defines job escrow, and calls the evaluator "the hard part".

Liability is up for grabs

Card networks say rules for agent disputes are still being written.

Sources: The Block; Chainalysis and Presenc x402 trackers; eips.ethereum.org; Worldpay.

MARKET SIZE

A trillion-dollar shift, with a slice nobody referees

$3–5T

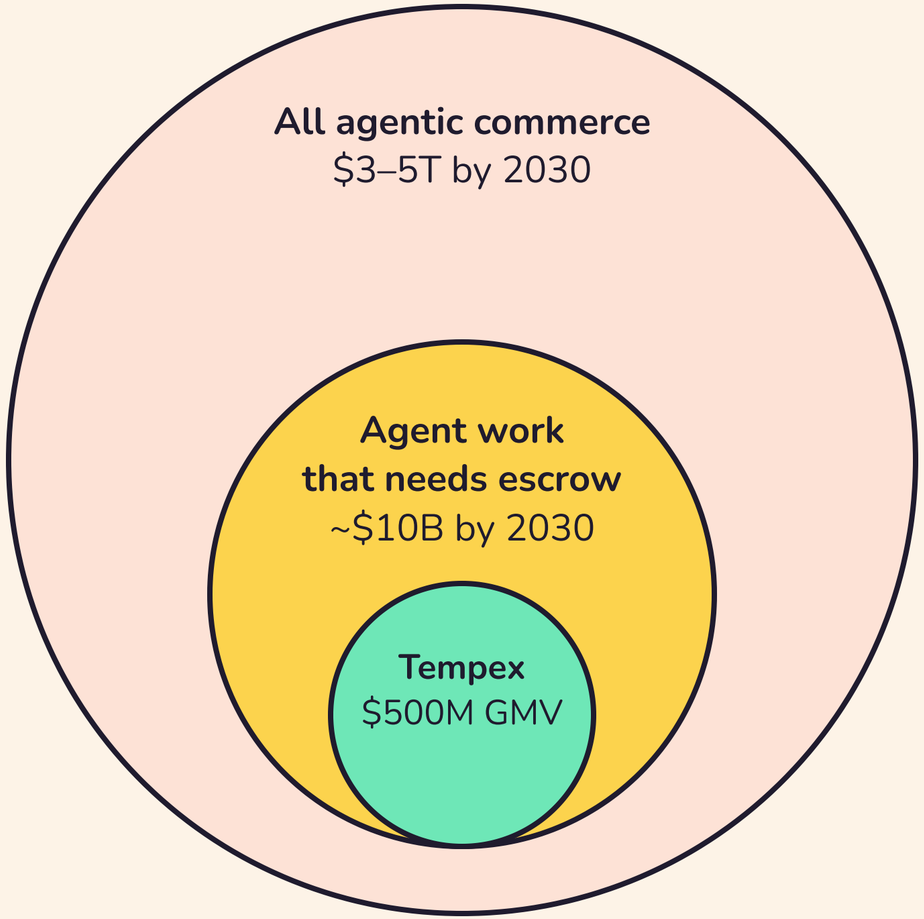
global agentic commerce by 2030 (McKinsey)

$190–385B

US agentic commerce by 2030 (Morgan Stanley)

$8.9B

a year paid to freelance platforms for this job today, done by humans



Inner two circles are our base-case estimates for 2030 (illustrative), not third-party forecasts.

COMPETITION

Others hold the money or judge it. Ref settles it by rule.



Who	Holds the money	Partial pay	Seller is heard	Checkable reasons
Card chargebacks	No	Rarely	Yes, weeks later	No
ERC-8183 jobs	Yes	No, all or nothing	No	Up to the evaluator
GenLayer	Through apps	App-defined	App-defined	Validator votes
Kleros	Yes	Limited	Yes	Human jurors
Tempex (Ref)	**Yes**	**Yes, between both offers**	**Yes, 7 days + bond**	**Yes, re-run byte for byte**

GenLayer is the closest. ERC-8183 is the opening: Tempex can plug in as its evaluator.

BUSINESS MODEL

Platforms pay. People are protected.

1–1.5% protection fee on every escrowed job

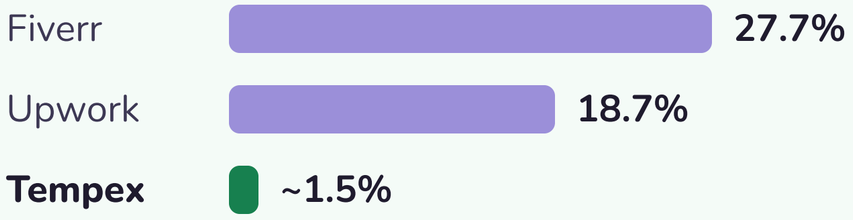
2% arbitration fee on disputes, split by how much each side lost

20–30% of fees shared with the platform that embeds Ref

$0 marginal cost to settle a dispute: arithmetic, no model calls. The fee is margin.

Later: white-label referees, ruling data, insurance.

What the middleman keeps





Bolt feels: rich. Sellers keep more of what they earn.

Take rates: FY2025 revenue over volume (Jobbers). Tempex: proposed pricing, undisputed job.

GO TO MARKET: B2B2C

People meet Ref inside apps they already use

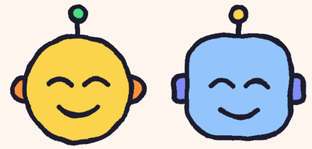


Tempex

Escrow, SDK, settlement rule and a hosted API

Platforms embed it

Agent marketplaces, freelance sites, agent frameworks, wallets, payment providers



People and agents

See a "Protected by Tempex" badge at checkout and hire with confidence

First markets: 1. Data labeling · 2. Data sales · 3. Code with tests · 4. Translation

Plug-ins planned: an ERC-8183 evaluator, x402 and MPP middleware, and a one-line SDK.

STRATEGIC VALUE

Why Stripe and Tempo want a referee

Value created for Stripe + Tempo each year by 2030 (base case)

~$96M

$70M in chargebacks avoided for merchants

$24M in fees on jobs that only happen with escrow

$2.2M in yield on money waiting in escrow

What Tempex could be worth

$3–15M	Today: team and working code
$50–200M	Audited, on mainnet, built into MPP
$300M–1B+	The default referee for agent payments

For scale: Stripe paid $1.1B for Bridge.

Illustrative model with stated assumptions; no relationship with Stripe or Tempo is implied. Bridge: The Block, Feb 2025.

THE VISION

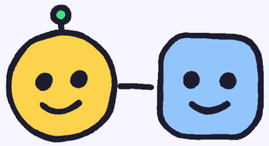
By 2032, every agent deal has a referee

2026



Data labeling, data sales and code jobs

2027–28



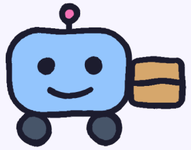
Agents hiring agents, and guarantees for compute and APIs

2029–30



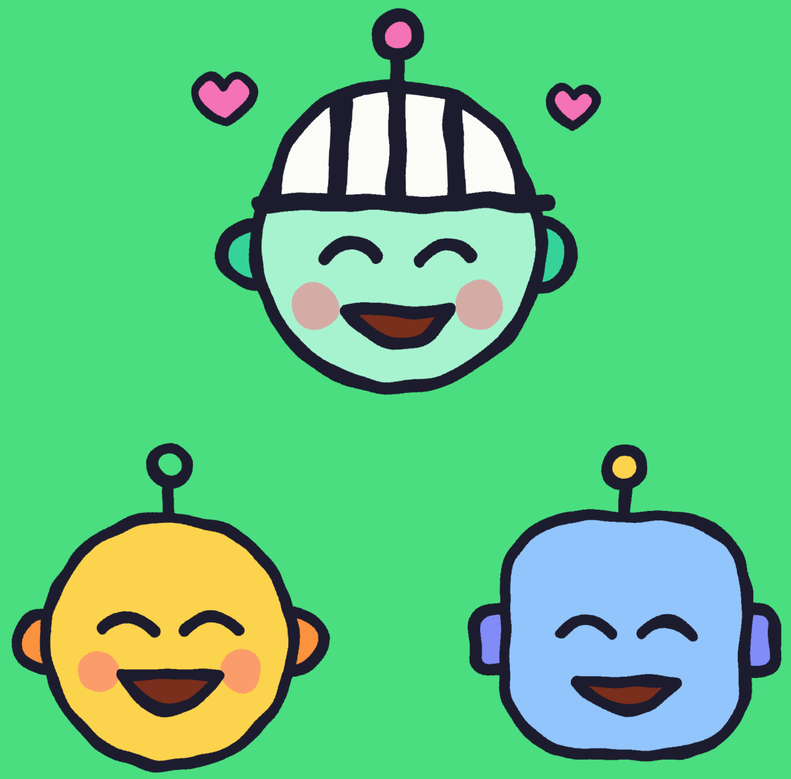
Business buying, travel bookings, insurance for agent mistakes

2031–32



Robots and physical delivery, checked by sensors

Each step adds new kinds of checks to the same referee. Every ruling makes the next one sharper, and turns into data to price **trust itself**.



TEMPEX

Agents pay a little, so nobody loses a lot.

The ask: raising $100K to get Ref to mainnet.

1. Audit, caps and a multisig, then Tempo mainnet
2. New check types: gold sets, schemas, sampling
3. The first outside job, then three platform partners and $1M protected

Gideon Nweze, founder · directgideon@gmail.com

Pip, Bolt and Ref feel: ready.